

LDSCI7237 Artificial Intelligence Dissertation Project AE2

Assessment Details

Course Leader:	Fatemeh Parsa
First, Second, or Third Sitting:	First & Second
Issue Date:	10 February 2026
Assessment Type:	Individual
Assessment Title:	Dissertation
Restrictions on Time/Length:	Up to 10,000 words
Assessment Weighting:	60%
Hand-in Deadline:	By 1pm (GMT) on Friday 21 August 2026
Planned Feedback Deadline:	28 calendar days after hand-in deadline or last presentation date
File Format Accepted:	PDF
Mode of Submission:	Online (Canvas)
Anonymous Submission:	No
Marking Scheme:	Categorical

	Permitted	Use of AI is allowed as the artefact. Use of AI is prohibited otherwise.
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Assessment Task

Complete a dissertation on an approved topic. You may consider the following indicative layout for your report.

- **Abstract.** This is no more than one side - which summarizes the content of the report. It must be comprehensible to someone who has not read the rest of the report.
- **Introduction.** Introduce your project by outlining the topic and stating its scope or objectives. Set out the background context, your motivation for the project, and the key goals you aimed to achieve.

- **Background.** A review of relevant literature, tools, technologies, or theories that support your project. This chapter should show your understanding of the field and justify your choices by relating your work to existing work.
- **Work undertaken.** Several chapters describing the work that has been undertaken. A detailed account of the design, development, experimentation, or analysis carried out. This should be split into clear sections that reflect the different phases of your project
- **Outputs.** A chapter describing the outputs, deliverables or artefacts that have been produced as a result of the project.
- **Further work.** Discuss how your project could be improved or extended in future. Identify any unresolved challenges, suggest enhancements, or outline new directions for further exploration.
- **Conclusion.** Summaries your findings, reflect on what you achieved in relation to your original goals, and comment on the overall success and limitations of your work.
- **References.** A complete list of sources cited in the report, using a consistent academic referencing style (e.g., APA, or Harvard).
- **Appendices.** Any appendices that as required.

Assessment Criteria

Projects will be assessed according to the following five criteria: Background Research, Project Management, Achievement, Report, and Artefact.

Background research:

This criterion assesses the background research undertaken and the manner in which the approach and programme of work fits in with the current state of the art:

- Relevant and breadth of sources
- Clear justification of project direction
- Proper citation of existing academic and technical work

Project management:

This criterion assesses the overall approach to the project and the students' ability to overcome the inevitable complications which arise. Specific areas of assessment are management and organisation, including time and risk management:

- Time and risk management
- Use of appropriate tools and technologies
- Independent and consistent progress
- Attendance at supervisory meetings

Achievement:

The achievement criterion of the project should reflect its technical difficulty. Projects with low levels of risk, e.g., straightforward implementation projects, cannot be expected to score very highly in this category.

- Ambition and challenge level
- Artefact quality and technical rigour
- Evidence of evaluation and testing
- Innovation and score for dissemination

Report:

The quality of the report should reflect the quality of the project. For example, a project that achieves first-class technical work should be supported by a well-written, clearly structured, and thoughtful report at a first-class standard. This includes:

- **Coherent and structured writing:** Ideas are presented in a logical flow with clear sectioning.
- **Clarity of purpose, methodology, and evaluation:** The report clearly explains what was done, how, and why, and includes meaningful analysis.
- **Academic writing proficiency:** Good use of grammar, spelling, and academic style throughout.
- **Correct referencing:** All sources are cited properly and consistently using an appropriate referencing style.

Artefact

You can submit your artefact in one of the following ways:

- As a **zipped folder** attached to your final submission, including all relevant files and instructions.
- By providing a **GitHub (or similar) repository link** that is public or shared with markers, clearly documented, and easy to navigate.

If your artefact cannot be opened, tested, or reviewed due to missing files, broken links, or access restrictions, this may affect your **Artefact** and **Achievement** marks.

The source code of any artefact produced for the project should be well organised, well written, and well structured. The assessment criteria for the artefact are:

Dissertation Marking Rubric

Criteria	70 or higher (First Class)	60-69 (Upper Second Class)	50-59 (Lower Second Class)	40-49 (Third Class)	39 or below (Fail)
1. Background Research	Shows excellent understanding of the topic with wide reading. Builds clearly on past research and identifies useful gaps. Sources are well chosen and fully cited.	Demonstrates good understanding with relevant reading. Some gaps are identified, and sources are used appropriately. Citations are mostly complete.	Covers basic research with limited detail or critical thinking. Few gaps in past work are discussed. Citations are used but may be incomplete or inconsistent.	Research is minimal and understanding is weak. Existing work is briefly mentioned but not well explained. Citations are inconsistent or missing in places.	Shows little to no understanding of past research. Fails to explain how existing work relates to the project. References are missing or incorrectly used.
2. Project Management	Excellent planning and consistent progress throughout. Risks were identified early with backup plans in place. Worked independently and used tools effectively.	Project was generally well managed with good progress. Some risks were identified and handled. Needed occasional guidance but worked mostly independently.	Project was managed adequately but with uneven progress. Relied on supervision at key points. Time or risk planning was basic.	Planning was weak and progress was slow. Showed dependence on supervision. Meetings or check-ins were missed.	Poor or no planning shown. Project fell behind and key milestones were missed. Little or no engagement with supervisor.
3. Achievement	Completed a complex and ambitious project successfully. Work is fully functional, well tested, and clearly exceeds expectations. Shows originality and real technical depth.	Project is mostly complete with good functionality. Some minor issues are present, but the work is solid and effective. Some creative or thoughtful	Work is basic and mostly works but may include bugs or gaps. The project is simple and mostly relies on standard methods. Evaluation is	Project is incomplete or has serious flaws. Some functionality exists, but parts are broken or missing. Evaluation is weak or unclear.	Very little has been achieved. The project does not run or is largely incomplete. There is no real testing or useful output.

		elements are shown.	present but limited.		
4. Report Quality	The report is clear, well organised, and easy to follow. Writing is polished with no major language or grammar issues. Conclusions are thoughtful and supported by the results.	The report is mostly well written and well structured. Some minor issues in writing or flow are present. Results and conclusions are generally clear.	The structure is basic, and writing has noticeable issues. Explanation of methods or results may be unclear. Some conclusions are present but underdeveloped.	Writing and structure are weak and difficult to follow. Key sections are missing or poorly explained. The report is hard to understand.	Report is disorganised and very hard to read. Many sections are missing or incomplete. Conclusions are not included or not related to the work.
5. Artefact Quality	The artefact is well written, organised, and fully functional. It shows strong technical skill and creativity. It meets or exceeds all project goals.	The artefact works well with minor issues. It is mostly organised and shows good understanding. Project goals are met.	The artefact meets minimum requirements but may be buggy or messy. Code structure is basic but readable. Key functionality is present.	The artefact is incomplete or unreliable. Code is poorly written or difficult to understand. Only part of the project works.	The artefact does not work or is missing. Code is disorganised or not usable. No meaningful functionality is shown.

Criterion	Weightage
Background Research	15%
Project Management	15%
Achievement	25%
Report	25%
Artefact	20%

How the Rubric to be used:

1. Each part of the dissertation should be assessed separately using the criteria described in the marking rubric.
2. For each criterion, a mark based on how well the work matches the descriptions in each performance level will be assigned.
3. Comments for each criterion, highlighting strengths and areas for improvement in relation to each criterion, will be provided.

4. The overall mark using the weightings assigned to each criterion (see table above) will be calculated. This ensures that the final grade reflects both the quality of the research, the artefact produced, and the written report, in line with the intended learning outcomes.
5. An overall score of 80 and above indicates that the work meets publication-ready standards and demonstrates high-quality research and presentation. This grade should reflect a high level of achievement across most or all criteria.

Submitting Assessments

You have three submission attempts, but only the last submission will be graded. If your last submission attempt is late, you will receive the late penalty even if you have a previous submission that was on time. Please make sure to avoid multiple submissions for assessments with multiple components, as only the last attempt will be graded. Upload several files in one submission attempt using the 'add files' function instead.

If you encounter issues with submission:

- Check the assessment details table at the top of the assessment brief to be sure you are submitting a permitted file format. Avoid zip files (unless explicitly required) and scanned PDFs. Use the 'add files' function to submit multiple files instead of a zip file.
- Make sure you have ticked the agreement box at the bottom of your Canvas submission page (scroll down if you don't see it). This will enable you to select 'Submit Assessment.'
- Try changing web browsers.

If you still cannot submit, e-mail a copy of your assignment before the deadline to student.assessments@nulondon.ac.uk along with screenshots of the problem on Canvas, showing a timestamp.

If your assessment requires anonymous submission (see the assessment details table at the top of the assessment brief), be sure you have left your name off of your submission and out of the submission file name.

Please review the submitted file to ensure that everything is in order. To turn on notifications for submission confirmation emails in your Canvas settings: Account > Notifications > Turn on the bell for 'All submissions.' In the app this is via Settings > Email Notifications > All submissions.

If you are submitting a physical artefact, you must also provide clear and thorough documentation (such as in the form of photographs or a video) of your submission by the deadline. To submit a video recording, select the green 'Panopto video' icon in the text entry box in your submission portal. You can upload a video file of any

format from your media library by selecting 'upload,' choosing 'my folder' in the drop-down menu, and clicking 'insert.' Play the video back once it processes to make sure that it has been embedded successfully. See an illustrated guide to submission using Panopto here: [How to Submit a Media File Through Panopto](#). ONLY submissions made in this format will be accepted; avoid submitting links or videos hosted on external platforms.

Marking

The University uses two assessment marking schemes – one for undergraduate and one for postgraduate – to mark all taught programmes leading to an award of the University.

More detailed information on the assessment marking scheme and the criteria can be found in the Course Syllabus, available on the University's VLE.

Learning Outcomes

This assessment will enable students to demonstrate in full or in part the learning outcomes identified in the Course Descriptor.

On successful completion of this assessment, students should be able to:

Knowledge and Understanding

- K1d Identify, analyse, and interpret requirements to solve a problem rigorously (e.g., formulate a thesis statement, identify steps to prove it, and substantiate your findings with data).
- K2d Demonstrate detailed critical engagement with methods, tools and technologies required to solve a problem (e.g., philosophical devices or software libraries).
- K3d Demonstrate a sophisticated understanding of (qualitative or quantitative) data analysis principles, tools and techniques.
- K4d Critical review of related work, identifying key developments in a particular area, opportunities for integration, limitations and avenues for further development and innovation.

Subject-Specific Skills

- S1d Ability to engage in a peer review process that involves critical review of ideas, arguments, software and related documentation, coupled with positive actions, advice for improvement and innovation.
- S2d Ability to recognise the individual components required to solve a problem or answer a question and combine them into a coherent argument or solution.
- S3d Develop original arguments based on solid background work and coupled with positive actions for improvement and innovation.

- S4d Familiarity with codes of ethics and codes of practice that underpin the development of high quality, high integrity research projects.

Transferable Skills

- T1d Project leadership skills, from understanding a problem to proposing a solution based on sound insights, to encouraging others to share that vision.
- T2d Consistently display an excellent level of technical proficiency in written English and command of scholarly terminology, so as to be able to deal with complex issues in a sophisticated and systematic way.
- T3d Research and analytical skills with a range of up-to-date, well-proven tools and resources.
- T4d Communicate effectively the intellectual merit and broader impacts of the project to specialist and non-specialist audiences.

Accessing Feedback

Students can expect to receive feedback on all summative coursework within 28 calendar days of the submission deadline or, if applicable, the last oral assessment date, whichever later. The 28 calendar day deadline does not apply to work submitted late. Feedback can be accessed through the assessment link on the Canvas course page.

Late Submissions

Please ensure that you submit your assignment well before the deadline to avoid any late penalties, as a submission made exactly on the deadline will be considered late. Please keep in mind that there may be differences between your computer's clock and the server time, which can cause discrepancies, and that Canvas may take some time to process your submission.

Your Canvas submission portal displays two due dates: one is the deadline for your assignment, and the second is the latest possible date by which your assignment can be submitted late. Please make sure you submit by the assessment deadline in order to avoid late penalties.

If assessments are submitted late without approved Extenuating Circumstances, there are penalties:

- For assessment elements submitted up to one day late, any passing mark will receive 10 marks deducted or a threshold pass (40% for undergraduate students, 50% for postgraduate students), whichever is higher. Any mark below 40% for undergraduate students and below 50% for postgraduate students will stand.
- Students who do not submit their assessment within one day of the deadline, and have no approved Extenuating Circumstances, are deemed not to have

submitted and to have failed that assessment element. The mark recorded will be 0%.

- For assessment subelements, late submission will result in non-submission penalties deducted according to the marking criteria above.

For further information, please refer to [AQF7 Part C in the Academic Handbook](#).

Extenuating Circumstances

The University's Extenuating Circumstances (ECs) procedure is in place if there are genuine circumstances that may prevent a student from submitting an assessment. If the EC application is successful, there will be no academic penalty for missing the published submission deadline.

Students are normally expected to apply for ECs in advance of the assessment deadline. Students may apply for consideration of ECs retrospectively if they can provide evidence that they could not have done so in advance of the deadline. All applications for ECs must be supported by independent evidence.

Successful EC applications for live oral assessments, including vivas, will result in a deferral of the oral to be organized by faculty, students, and Timetabling for a date as close as possible to the original presentation date. The deadline for supplementary materials, if assigned, will be carried forward by the length of the oral assessment extension.

Missing an oral assessment, including a compulsory viva, without an approved EC will result in a non-submission for the entire assessment and, accordingly, a recorded mark of 0%.

Students are reminded that the ECs procedure covers only short-term issues (within 21 days leading to the submission deadline) and that if they experience longer-term matters that impact on learning then they must contact [Student Support](#) for advice.

Under the Extenuating Circumstances Policy, students may defer an assessed element on only one occasion and may request an extension on a maximum of two occasions.

For further information, please refer to the [Extenuating Circumstances Policy](#) in the Academic Handbook.

Academic Misconduct

You must submit work for assessment purposes that is your own and meets good academic practice. Assessments must be completed strictly in accordance with the instructions outlined in the assessment brief. This includes ensuring that your work is appropriately referenced.

It is important to understand if artificial intelligence (AI) is permitted to be used or not, and if yes, the conditions for its use. For clarity, the assessment brief expressly states if AI can be used, and the parameters of its permitted usage. You are not

permitted to use AI (in any form) if the assessment brief does not expressly state that usage is permitted.

Any concerns with the academic integrity of a submission will be addressed in accordance with the [Academic Misconduct Policy](#). This policy gives details of the different types of misconduct and the steps the University may take when a concern arises. Action may result in academic penalties being applied directly to you. You are advised to review this policy in full before completing and submitting any work for marking purposes. The University may also take steps to ascertain the authenticity of a submitted piece of work in cases of relevant concern, such as by holding a viva.

Version History

Title: Assessment Brief Template					
Approved by: The Quality Team					
Version number	Date approved	Date published	Owner	Location	Proposed next review date
4.0	March 2023	March 2023	Registrar	VLE/ Faculty Resources Page	March 2024
3.0	August 2022	August 2022	Registrar	VLE, Faculty Resources Page	July 2023
2.3	December 2021	December 2021	Registrar	VLE	August 2022
2.2	August 2021	August 2021	Registrar	VLE	August 2022
2.1	September 2020	September 2020	Registrar	VLE	August 2021
2.0	September 2020	September 2020	Registrar	VLE	August 2021
1.0	August 2019	August 2019	Registrar	VLE	August 2020
Referenced documents	AQF7 Academic Regulations for Taught Awards; Extenuating Circumstances Policy; Academic Misconduct Policy; Course Syllabus				
External Reference Point(s)	UK Quality Code Theme: Assessment				